

Steak Frites with Chimichurri

1) Overview & Station Setup

- Owner: Priya Nair (Sous Chef, Grill)
- Summary: Hanger steak, double-fried frites, chimichurri made fresh each shift.
- House spec: Medium-rare pull at 130°F with 5 min rest. Frites are blanched then finished to order. Chimichurri is made per shift and discarded at end of shift.

Station tools

- Grill, fryers, instant-read thermometer, timers
- Cutting board (green for herbs), chef's knife, microplane, mixing bowls
- 1 qt deli, squeeze bottles (green cap), label tape, Sharpie
- Sheet pans with cooling racks, spider, fry baskets, hotel pans with perforated inserts, heat lamp
- Tongs, offset spatula

2) Chimichurri (per shift, 1 qt)

Original spec to keep: Parsley 2 bunches, oregano ½ bunch, garlic 6 cloves, red wine vinegar 120 ml, olive oil 360 ml, chili flake 1 tsp, salt to taste. Label with time made; discard at end of shift.

Procedure (make once at lineup; yield about 1 qt)

1. Pick parsley (2 bunches) and oregano (½ bunch). Rough chop to keep some texture; no puree.
2. Microplane or very fine mince 6 cloves garlic.
3. In a bowl, combine herbs, garlic, red wine vinegar 120 ml (~1/2 cup), olive oil 360 ml (~1 1/2 cups), chili flake 1 tsp.
4. Add salt to taste. Mix. Rest 10 minutes to bloom.
5. Transfer to a 1 qt deli; fill squeeze bottles as needed. Label with time made; discard at end of shift. Do not keep overnight.

Notes

- Flavor target: bright acidity, loose but not oily pool, visible herb pieces. If too sharp, add a pinch more salt, not sugar.
- All cold-hold at 41°F or below. Keep bottles on ice bath if parked on the line.

3) Steak: Prep, Cook, Rest

Original spec to keep: 8 oz hanger, trimmed of membrane. Season 30 min before cooking. Grill to temp: MR = 130°F pull, rest 5 min.

Prep

6. Trim hanger of silver skin and membrane; portion 8 oz each. Keep grain orientation noted for slicing.
7. Season 30 minutes before cooking with kosher salt and black pepper. Pan on speed rack, uncovered, in lowboy.

Fire to order (house spec MR)

8. Hot grill, clean grates, oil lightly.
9. Sear steak, crosshatch marks for even Maillard. Flip as needed.
10. Check internal with probe; pull at 130°F for medium-rare.
11. Rest 5 minutes on resting rack; do not tent. Carryover finishes cook.
12. Slice across the grain if requested by Expo; otherwise serve whole as spec.

If guest requests other doneness (on Expo approval)

- House spec is MR. Cook other temps only on request and note pull temps:

Doneness	Pull Temp (°F)	Notes
Rare	120–125	Very red, cool-to-warm center
Medium-rare (house)	130	Juicy, warm red center
Medium	135–140	Pink center, less juice
Med-well	145–150	Slight blush
Well	155+	No pink; baste with fat to prevent dryness

Tips

- Hanger is uneven; move thicker end to hotter zone. Avoid flare-ups; trim excess surface fat.
- If steak hits temp too fast, rest longer; flash 10–15 sec per side to reheat if needed after rest.

4) Frites: Blanch and Finish

Original spec to keep: Blanch at 325°F for 5 min, cool on racks, finish at 375°F for 2–3 min to order. See SOP: Fryer Oil Filtering & Change Schedule for oil quality checks.

Blanch (par cook)

13. Heat fryer to 325°F. Load fries in basket no more than 1/2 full.
14. Fry 5 minutes. Do not brown; aim for pale, flexible.
15. Shake, drain, and cool on racks on sheet pans. Do not stack hot; steam will sog them.

Finish to order

16. Heat fryer to 375°F.
17. Fry 2–3 minutes until golden and crisp. Listen for crisp sound when tapped.
18. Drain well; toss with fine salt immediately. Hold under lamp in perforated hotel pan, 2–3 minutes max.

Oil management

- Follow SOP: Fryer Oil Filtering & Change Schedule.
- Signs to change sooner: slow fry times, dark smoke at temp, bitter smell, poor crisp.

Frites timing quick table

- Blanch: 325°F, 5 min
- Finish: 375°F, 2–3 min
- Pass hold: under lamp, 2–3 min max

5) Plating & Expo Call

- Warm oval plate. No pooling oil.
- Pile frites high, 8 oz portion by volume check; season check.
- Place steak right of fries, juices contained; wipe rim.
- Chimichurri: generous spoon over steak, plus a 1 oz ramekin on the side if requested.
- Expo call: “Steak frites MR, chimi, drop fries.”

6) Quality Checks

Steak

- Even grill marks, no burnt edges, hot plate, rested slice shows rosy MR.
- Probe reads 130°F at pull; juices clear but red.

Frites

- Golden, crisp outside, fluffy center. No grease slick on plate.
- Salted hot, not pale, not dark mahogany.

Chimichurri

- Bright green, loose emulsion, garlic present but not harsh, acidic pop.

7) Troubleshooting and What-To-Do-If

- Fries soggy: Overloaded basket or oil too cool. Reduce batch size, confirm 375°F recovery, extend finish by 30–45 sec.
- Fries too dark fast: Oil old or too hot. Check SOP, drop temp 5–10°F, skim crumbs.
- Steak under after rest: Quick kiss on hot zone 20–30 sec per side; re-check.
- Steak over: Do not serve. Fire a new steak; overcook gets family meal.
- Chimi bitter: Herbs over-processed. Remake with hand-chop. If vinegar bite is harsh, add a pinch of salt and 1–2 tsp olive oil to round; do not add sugar.
- Grill flare-ups: Move steak, scrape grate, wipe with oiled towel, relight section if needed.

8) Food Safety and Line Discipline

- Raw beef below ready-to-eat. Separate tongs for raw and cooked. Sanitize boards/knives every 4 hours or when soiled.
- Cold-hold sauces at 41°F or below. Chimichurri: label with time made; discard at end of shift.
- Verify fryer temps with thermometer; no guessing. Use timers for blanch/finish.
- Resting racks keep meat out of pooled juices; no resting directly on cutting board.
- Allergens: Chimichurri contains garlic; fries share fryer—confirm with Expo if any cross-contact concern.